Security, privacy and responsible AI

The app can assist with HR work while keeping permissions, evidence and human authority separate. An AI recommendation is not permission to act.

Read the status labels

Implemented means a control exists in the reviewed application. Configuration required means an approved policy, authority, provider or operational evidence is still needed. Roadmap means additional capability is not established as complete. Deployment evidence not verified means we need separate proof, not that the capability is absent.

What this guide covers

Security, privacy, document trust, responsible-AI controls and metrics, the agent execution harness and the testing harness. The companion register provides individual controls, evidence pointers and limitations.

What it does not certify

No claim of universal regulatory compliance, genuine documents, correct AI answers, bias-free decisions or complete attack prevention. No live tenant metrics, production settings or fresh test results were collected for this pack.

Where users work

Control Tower provides cases, approvals, Action Center, policies, Guardrails, Audit, Systems and UAT. Employee Vault and Cost-Benefit Explorer are separate applications; access and configured workflow availability differ.

Register: SEC-01–09; all eight control families.

Who can see data and authorize work?

Signing in, belonging to a client organization and holding professional authority are different things.

Organization and case boundaries

Client records are scoped to organizations and relevant cases. Groups and permissions govern fields, flows and tools; temporary grants can expire or be revoked.

Human and agent identity

Named people and registered agent versions have defined execution scope. An agent cannot grant itself additional permissions by writing them into a request.

Specialist authority and approvals

Tenant owners and mailbox personas do not automatically become legal, medical, privacy or payroll approvers. Approved policy revisions and current evidence determine consequential authority; drafts remain proposals.

Candidate access is limited

Candidate portal links have their own scoped, expiring access lifecycle. Such a link is not a full staff or employer account.

Register: SEC-01–09; RUN-02. Specialist authority setup is configuration-dependent.

Safe communications and privacy

Messages should reach authorized people, and incoming content must not become instructions to the system.

Verified and bounded channels

Configured webhook signatures, sender rules, case binding, recipient authorization and duplicate/self-echo controls protect communication paths. Sending, calling and voice-turn limits reduce runaway activity.

Untrusted messages and sensitive topics

Text and speech are evidence, not commands. Structured decisions and prompt-injection fences constrain responses. Sensitive topics route to people rather than an unrestricted AI answer.

Sensitive records and disclosure

Approved policies govern collection and sharing. Unknown or opaque content is not automatically safe. Model evidence is restricted, contacts are masked in relevant audit paths and inputs are bounded.

Retention and analytics

Reviewed retention rules and legal holds govern cleanup. Analytics restricts sensitive disclosure and uses a local deterministic narrative; a privacy badge is not a guarantee that every possible report is safe.

Register: COM-01–06; PRI-01–04 and PRI-07; AI-02–04. Policy/channel setup may be required.

Document trust and Employee Vault

A file can be readable and malware-safe while still being forged. Source authenticity and file safety are separate checks.

Uploads, scanning and review

Private, bounded upload handling tracks incomplete writes. Quarantine or unavailable safety evidence cannot be bypassed to finish a checklist. Local parsing or an AI plausibility judgment does not authenticate a certificate.

Employee-owned evidence

Vault ownership is separate from employer membership. Sharing needs consent, current employer-case binding and all required eligible checks; identity-only clearance is not a full background check.

Signed source results

Approved issuer configuration verifies signed results bound to the person and exact document version. Expired, changed or mismatched evidence cannot establish current reuse. Live source coverage depends on approved issuer/provider connections.

Withdrawal and expiry notices

Employees can withdraw future sharing authority. Private opt-in in-app notices warn of eligible expiry, but do not renew checks, extend consent or send verified email automatically. Earlier lawful disclosures are not retroactively undone.

Register: DOC-01–07. Expanding live issuer coverage is roadmap; signed-result infrastructure already exists.

The agent execution harness

The harness is the set of controls around execution—not another model and not permission to automate every decision.

Bound the transaction

Unified context ties organization, subject, initiator, executor/version, parent attempt and correlation together. It rejects incompatible scope and does not store prompts, answers or documents in history.

Check current authority before effects

Policy, permissions, holds and evidence gates constrain consequential dispatch. The exact registered AI payload has input/output budgets; mandatory evidence is not silently dropped to fit.

Recover without blind duplication

Checkpoints and a durable effect journal fence concurrency and recovery. Supported idempotent operations can reuse their logical key; an ambiguous non-idempotent effect must stop for reconciliation.

Investigate and retain safely

Own history and separately authorized operator history expose bounded metadata, filters and older pages. History does not grant retry authority. Approved retention preserves unfinished or unsafe chains and respects holds.

Register: RUN-01–06; PRI-05–06; AI-05. Context continuity is not a second workflow engine.

The testing harness and audit evidence

Execution controls enforce rules. Tests and recorded evidence show what happened under the conditions examined.

Guardrails and security drills

The Guardrails catalogue describes 13 communications-related controls and recorded interventions. Independently authorized delivery-denied security drills exercise selected enforcement boundaries. This catalogue is a subset of the wider control register.

UAT and regression checks

UAT distinguishes observed workflow evidence, run-owned fixtures, manual work and blocked steps. Unit, integration and browser checks support change assurance. A test found in code is not a claim that the latest test passed.

Historical evidence

Historical test records are read-only and non-operational. They are not payroll, access or background-check execution. Retired volunteer communications cannot be retried.

Protected audit and launch gates

Local protected audit is tamper-evident, not independently immutable by itself. Approved external anchoring, verified receipts and drills establish stronger assurance. The regulated startup guard is opt-in for selected tenants, not an automatically enabled universal guarantee.

Register: TST-01–04; AUD-01–04. Live providers, alert channels and independent evidence require configuration.

What we measure—and what we do not

Responsible AI needs defined measurements. Operational activity is useful, but is not proof of correct or fair decisions.

Grounded answers and read-only explanations

Policy answers use approved extracts and exact quotation validation, with fresh source and disclosure checks. Insufficient or conflicting material can prevent an answer. Case explanations describe recorded evidence, not hidden reasoning or invented historical rationale, and cannot change case state.

Available operational evidence

Recorded guardrail interventions and drill steps show selected control activity. Execution metadata shows status, timestamps and steps. Human-review, autonomy and exception indicators are derived from recorded cases and approvals.

Important measurement limits

Guardrail recording is bounded; counts are not exhaustive attack volume. Human-review history is not necessarily a completed decision. No approval record does not prove safe autonomy. Execution completion is not business success.

AI budgets and unavailable outcome measures

Input-byte bounds and output-token allowances establish request limits, not actual usage, cost or answer correctness. The main Analytics summary currently has insufficient data for SLA performance and average resolution time.

Responsible-AI evaluation roadmap

Measure correctness, unsupported claims, appropriate abstention, fairness differences and privacy leakage against approved ground truth and defined samples. Benchmark and fairness work is underway separately; no measured results or completed scorecard are claimed here.

Register: AI-01–07; MET-01–12. Every published rate needs a scope, denominator, source, period and limitation.

Remaining assurance work and business checks

Existing controls reduce risk. Stronger assurance still depends on configured sources, operational evidence and independent review.

Compliance and authenticity roadmap

Build consolidated obligation-to-control evidence packs and assessments. Add validated issuer/provider connections and revocation/freshness coverage for required document types. Existing governance and signed results are not absent—but are not universal coverage.

Answer quality and fairness roadmap

Business-reviewed benchmark questions, broader support checks, deterministic rules where appropriate and a governed fairness/challenge programme strengthen assurance. Never use model confidence alone as ground truth or collect protected traits without separately approved safeguards.

Deployment facts to verify

Obtain evidence for identity-provider posture, encryption/key management, residency, AI-provider data-use terms, incident response, backup recovery and any claimed certifications. Code review alone does not establish these.

Before approving a live rollout

Confirm scoped access and specialist authority; approved privacy and retention rules; configured providers/scanners; current audit protection; relevant test evidence; defined metrics and escalation ownership. Treat unresolved assurance as an explicit gap.

Register: MAP-01–05; DEP-01–06. Evidence owners are suggested reviewer roles, not assigned accountability.